

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Easy

Question
 $x + y = 75$

The equation above relates the number of minutes, x , Maria spends running each day and the number of minutes, y , she spends biking each day. In the equation, what does the number 75 represent?

- Answer
- A. The number of minutes spent running each day
 - B. The number of minutes spent biking each day
 - C. The total number of minutes spent running and biking each day
 - D. The number of minutes spent biking for each minute spent running

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. Maria spends x minutes running each day and y minutes biking each day. Therefore, $x + y$ represents the total number of minutes Maria spent running and biking each day. Because $x + y = 75$, it follows that 75 is the total number of minutes that Maria spent running and biking each day.

Choices A and B are incorrect. The number of minutes Maria spent running each day is represented by x and need not be 75. Similarly, the number of minutes that Maria spends biking each day is represented by y and need not be 75. The number of minutes Maria spends running each day and biking each day may vary; however, the total number of minutes she spends each day on these activities is constant and equal to 75. Choice D is incorrect. The number of minutes Maria spent biking for each minute spent running cannot be determined from the information provided.